Need to use a proper script for Samskritam

Even though Bhagavan understands all languages, the power of our Bharatiya languages cannot be matched in expressing our cultural values especially when rising to the plane of conversing with Bhagavan. Of them, the Samskrita bhasha is special in that it is pan-Bharatiya. Hence our scriptures, anushthana paddhati-s and a lot of bhakti sahitya texts are in Samskrita only.

We know that in Samskritam, especially for anushthanam, sound/pronunciation is important. Therefore one should write and read sankalpa shloka-s etc for anushthanam in an appropriate script which is capable of distinguishing all the sounds of Samskritam.

Now the Latin (English) script was evolved for other languages, and we all know the difficulty of correlating spelling and pronunciation even in English. Further, more letters are required to write Samskritam than English as there are more sounds in it. However, since Latin script is widely known, scholars felt it useful to create a Latin-based transliteration system for Samskritam.

In such a system, Latin letters which may be casually applied to different sounds need to be differentiated. For instance in Rama the first or second "a" may denote a long sound. This is differentiated as Rāma or Ramā. Similarly, other marks called diacritics are used to differentiate sounds as in aā iī uū rṛṝ lḷḹ mṃ hḥ nṅñṇ tṭ dḍ sśṣ. Aspirated (mahāprāna) sounds are denoted with an additional h as in k/kh, g/gh, c/ch, j/jh, ṭ/ṭh, ḍ/ḍh, t/th, d/dh, p/ph, b/bh.

However, a system is useful only if followed correctly. If diacritics or added h-s are ignored and we do not read with the intended pronunciation, then the transliteration is no longer useful for its intended purpose. It is very easy to ignore diacritics as they are not in daily use. It would then have altogether been better to use a script which actually has different symbols for the sounds.

Therefore **it is strongly recommended to learn a Bharatiya script** like Devanagari, Grantha, Telugu, Kannada etc **which has clearly different letters to denote the various sounds**. Our documents are published in many such scripts.

However, with a view to help people who are not able to immediately learn such scripts, we are now publishing documents in Latin transliteration as well as per the system called International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration (IAST). For the above reasons, people should use these as a temporary measure till they learn a Bharatiya script.

The Samskrita varnamala in IAST is given below with Devanagari equivalents:

a अ, ā आ, i इ, ī ई, u उ, ū ऊ, ṛ ऋ, ṝ ॠ, ḷ ऌ, ḹ ॡ

e ए, ai ऐ, o ओ, au औ, aṃ अं, aḥ अः

ka क, kha ख, ga ग, gha घ, ṇa ङ

ca च, cha छ, ja ज, jha झ, ña ञ

ṭa ट, ṭha ठ, ḍa ड, ḍha ढ, ṇa ण

ta त, tha थ, da द, dha ध, na न

pa प, pha फ, ba ब, bha भ, ma म

ya य, ra र, la ल, va व, śa श, ṣa ष, sa स, ha ह

-o-

hara hara śaṅkara oṃ jaya jaya śaṅkara

śrī-vedavyāsāya namaḥ

śrīmad-ādya-śaṅkara-bhagavatpāda-paramparāgata-mūlāmnāya-sarvajña-pīṭham
śrī-kāñcī-kāmakoṭi-pīṭham
jagadguru-śrī-śaṅkarācārya-svāmi-śrīmaṭha-saṃsthānam

||kṛṣṇāṅgāraka-caturdaśī-yama-tarpaṇam||

5127 viśvāvasuḥ-mīnaḥ-3

kṛṣṇāṅgāraka-caturdaśī (**17.03.2026**)

dīpotsavacaturdaśyāṃ kāryaṃ tu yamatarpaṇam|
kṛṣṇāṅgāracaturdaśyām api kāryaṃ sadaiva vā||

kṛṣṇapakṣe caturdaśyām aṅgārakadinaṃ yadā|
tadā snātvā śubhe toye kurvīta yamatarpaṇam||

According to the above verses from Vaidyanatha Dīkshitīyam (Āhnika Kāṇḍa, Uttarārdha), on Naraka Chaturdashi and also on Krishna Angaraka Chaturdashi, i.e. when Chaturdashi of Krishna Paksha falls on a Tuesday, one must perform Yama Tarpanam.

jīvatpitā'pi kurvīta tarpaṇaṃ yamabhīṣmayoḥ

As per the above verse, Yama Tarpanam and Bhishma Tarpanam must be performed by even those whose fathers are alive.

veda-dharma-śāstra-paripālana-sabhā
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ekaikena tilairmiśrān dadyāt trīṃstrīn jalāñjalīn|
saṃvatsarakṛtaṃ pāpaṃ tatkṣaṇādeva naśyati||

kṛṣṇapakṣe caturdaśyāṃ yāṃ kāñcit saritaṃ prati|
yamunāyāṃ viśeṣeṇa niyatastarpayed yamam||

yatra kvacana nadyāṃ hi snātvā kṛṣṇacaturdaśīm|
santarpya dharmarājaṃ tu mucyate sarvakilbiṣaiḥ||

dakṣiṇābhimukho bhūtvā tilaiḥ savyaṃ samāhitaḥ|
devatīrthena devatvāt tilaiḥ pretādhipo yataḥ||

On such Krishna paksha Chaturdashi days, one must perform snānam in Yamuna or other rivers, and perform Tarpanam for Yama. Doing so, the papam accumulated over the entire year are destroyed instantly—such a lofty phalam is described for Yama Tarpanam.

Method of performing Tarpana — Facing South, offer water via Deva tirtha (the same way one performs Deva Tarpanam in Sandhyavandanam or Brahmayajna) along with black sesame seeds. Each time, offer water with sesame thrice.

yajñopavītinā kāryaṃ prācīnāvītinā'thavā As per the above verse, the Tarpanam can be performed by wearing the Yajnopavītam as Upavītī, or Prācīnāvītī.

saṅkalpaḥ

ācamanam| śuklāmbaradharaṃ + śāntaye| prāṇāyāmaḥ|
mamopāttasamastaduritakṣayadvārā śrīparameśvaraprītyarthaṃ śubhe śobhane muhūrte adya brahmaṇaḥ dvitīyaparārdhe śvetavarāhakalpe vaivasvatamanvantare aṣṭāviṃśatitame kaliyuge prathame pāde jambūdvīpe bhāratavarṣe bharatakhaṇḍe meroḥ dakṣiṇe pārśve asmin vartamāne vyāvahārikāṇāṃ prabhavādīnāṃ ṣaṣṭyāḥ saṃvatsarāṇāṃ madhye **viśvāvasu**-nāma-saṃvatsare **uttarāyaṇe śiśira**-ṛtau **mīna-phālguna**-māse **kṛṣṇa**-pakṣe **trayodaśyāṃ** (09:23) śubhatithau **bhauma**vāsarayuktāyāṃ **śraviṣṭhā**-nakṣatra (06:21; **śatabhiṣaṅ**-nakṣatra)yuktāyāṃ **siddha**-yoga

(08:13; **sādhya**-yoga)yuktāyāṃ **vaṇijā**-karaṇa (09:23; **bhadrā**-karaṇa)-yuktāyām evaṃ-guṇa-viśeṣaṇa-viśiṣṭāyām asyāṃ **trayodaśyāṃ** (09:23) yamadharmarājaprītyarthaṃ kṛṣṇāṅgāraka-caturdaśī-puṇyakāle ya-matarpaṇaṃ kariṣye|

tarpaṇa-mantrāḥ

1. yamaṃ tarpayāmi| yamaṃ tarpayāmi| yamaṃ tarpayāmi||
2. dharmarājaṃ tarpayāmi| dharmarājaṃ tarpayāmi| dharmarājaṃ tarpayāmi||
3. mṛtyuṃ tarpayāmi| mṛtyuṃ tarpayāmi| mṛtyuṃ tarpayāmi||
4. antakaṃ tarpayāmi| antakaṃ tarpayāmi| antakaṃ tarpayāmi||
5. vaivasvataṃ tarpayāmi| vaivasvataṃ tarpayāmi| vaivasvataṃ tarpayāmi||
6. kālaṃ tarpayāmi| kālaṃ tarpayāmi| kālaṃ tarpayāmi||
7. sarvabhūtakṣayaṃ tarpayāmi| sarvabhūtakṣayaṃ tarpayāmi| sarvabhū-takṣayaṃ tarpayāmi||
8. audumbaraṃ tarpayāmi| audumbaraṃ tarpayāmi| audumbaraṃ tar-payāmi||
9. dadhnaṃ tarpayāmi| dadhnaṃ tarpayāmi| dadhnaṃ tarpayāmi||
10. nīlaṃ tarpayāmi| nīlaṃ tarpayāmi| nīlaṃ tarpayāmi||
11. parameṣṭhinaṃ tarpayāmi| parameṣṭhinaṃ tarpayāmi| parameṣṭhinaṃ tarpayāmi||
12. vṛkodaraṃ tarpayāmi| vṛkodaraṃ tarpayāmi| vṛkodaraṃ tarpayāmi||
13. citraṃ tarpayāmi| citraṃ tarpayāmi| citraṃ tarpayāmi||
14. citraguptaṃ tarpayāmi| citraguptaṃ tarpayāmi| citraguptaṃ tar-payāmi||

Following this, perform Japa of the following names 10 times—

japaḥ—

yamo nihantā pitṛdharmarājo vaivasvato daṇḍadharaśca kālaḥ|
pretādhipo dattakṛtānusārī kṛtāntaḥ (etad daśakṛjjapanti)||

Following this, perform Namaskara—

namaskāraḥ—

nīlaparvatasaṅkāśo rudrakopasamudbhavaḥ|
kālo daṇḍadharo devo vaivasvata namo'stu te||